

Leadership Begins With Presence

LEADERSHIP BRIEF 01 • FROM *Trusted Intent: Why People Follow Leaders When It Matters Most*



A few years ago, my son called me upstairs, excited to show me something he had built. **Instead of seeing his excitement, I saw the flaw.**

I corrected the problem before I acknowledged the person. That moment reinforced a lesson I should have understood much earlier as a leader:

Presence is more than being in the room. It is noticing what matters in the moment.

People know when we are distracted. They know when we are waiting to respond instead of listening. And they know when we see the mistake before we see the effort.

Questions for Reflection

- Do the people you lead experience you as fully present, or merely physically there?
- Are you listening to understand, or simply preparing your response?
- When someone brings you an idea, problem, or accomplishment, do you first see the person or the flaw?
- If those closest to you were asked whether your intent is genuinely for them, would their answer be immediate and confident?

Focus Area for Growth

This week, practice complete presence in one important conversation each day - at work and at home.

- Put the phone away.
- Stop preparing your response.
- Listen to understand.
- Notice tone, body language, and emotion.
- Before correcting, ask whether the moment first calls for encouragement.

Before Your Next Important Conversation

With an employee, teammate, spouse, or child, ask yourself: *What does this person need from me in this moment - direction, correction, encouragement, or simply my full attention?*

“Let every person be quick to hear, slow to speak, slow to anger.” — James 1:19 (ESV)

ONE THOUGHT TO CARRY WITH YOU

Leadership is often revealed in the small moments when people need to know that you see them.

CONTINUE THE JOURNEY

BLAKE GLASS

This brief is drawn from *Trusted Intent: Why People Follow Leaders When It Matters Most*, where the full story and deeper leadership lesson are explored.

More Trusted Intent Leadership Briefs coming soon.